

We are building on past investment to find better solutions for land managers to control and reduce the impact of established non-native pest animals and weeds.

The program is:

- working with States and Territories to deliver on-ground management
- supporting Indigenous Ranger Groups in Northern Australia to undertake on-ground pest and weed management
- supporting actions identified under the Threatened Species Action Plan through natural resource management organisations
- funding research and development to advance a range of new control methods
- supporting national coordination to improve information sharing, coordination and adoption of best practice management
- improving data, to better our understanding of their impact and distribution

Funding

From 2021–22 to 2024–25, the program received a total of \$49.1 million in funding.

In the 2025–26 Budget, the Australian Government committed an additional \$11 million to continue national efforts targeting feral deer, pigs, foxes, and cats. This funding also supports Indigenous-led pest and weed management in northern Australia, research to improve control tools, and joint initiatives with state and territory governments to reduce and prevent pest animals and weeds.

Funding allocations were made in consultation with states and territories and in line with government financial guidelines. Program priorities are guided by national strategies and action plans.

Projects

In March 2022, then Minister for Agriculture and Northern Australia, and then Minister for the Environment, approved \$20 million for 30 state and territory-led projects (Tranche 2). These Tranche 2 projects are delivering on-ground management of established pest and weeds to reduce the impact on our agricultural production, our native wildlife and environment, and the community.

In July 2025, the Minister for Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry approved \$5 million for 26 state and territory-led projects (Tranche 3) to continue this work.

Our funding in Tranche 2 and Tranche 3 leverages over \$50 million from state and territory governments.

Projects are outlined below.

New South Wales

Tranche 3 (2025-26) funding: \$915,779

Agency: Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development; Department of Climate Change, Energy, Environment and Water

Project	Target species	Key activities
PIGCOUNT – proving on-ground feral pig control is effective	Feral pigs	Test and deliver a reliable, user-friendly monitoring tool (PIGCOUNT) for land managers to accurately estimate reductions in feral pig populations after control programs.
MidCoast Council public and private feral deer control program	Feral deer	Reduce and contain feral deer populations within existing footprint and reduce impact on public and threatened ecological communities, such as littoral rainforest and coastal wetlands.
Field application of novel eDNA-based surveillance tools to detect Amazon frogbit	Amazon frogbit	Develop a prototype surveillance strategy using eDNA to enhance delimitation efforts; Build capacity of weeds officers to sample eDNA and use assays; Manage infestations when detected; and fine-tune surveillance strategy for different regions.
Enhancing community and land manager capability for coastal weed management	Sea spurge, coast beach daisy, groundsel bush, glory lily, Italian buckthorn, arum lily	Improve the extent and efficacy of coastal weed management by analysing survey data, research and case studies; Produce recommendations to support communities and land managers; Increase awareness through information sharing.

Tranche 2 (2021-22 to 2024-25) funding: \$3,480,000

Agency: Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development

Project	Target species	Key activities
Releasing weed biocontrol agents – increasing numbers, coverage, and impact	Multiple weed species, including Weeds of National Significance	Fast track and optimise the release of weed biocontrol agents through increasing the area, extent, number, and types of agents released.

Better Predator Control	Wild dogs, red foxes, feral cats, and feral pigs	Enable more effective suppression of wild dogs, red foxes, feral cats, and feral pigs in highly productive areas (tablelands/escarpment) to reduce the impacts posed by surviving pests and immigrating animals causing ongoing problems.
Reducing feral deer and pig impacts in NSW hotspots	Feral deer and pigs	Significantly increase the area within the North-West and Central regions of NSW in which feral deer and pigs are controlled to low densities; Aerial- and ground-based shooting (both with thermal imaging) of deer and pigs, trapping and ground-baiting of pigs, and exclusion fencing (deer and pigs) – all methods that are highly effective in these landscapes.

Victoria

Tranche 3 (2025-26) funding: \$610,000

Agency: Parks Victoria, Department of Energy, Environment and Climate Action

Project	Target species	Key activities
Building the coastal weed army – protecting the coastal habitats and wildlife of East Gippsland through community weed control and partnerships	Sea spurge, coast beach daisy, blackberry, boxthorn, coastal gladioli, Dolichos pea, mirror bush, Kikuyu grass	Build upon planning and on-ground works; Control priority weed infestations; Contain them at the Far East Gippsland coastline; Reduce impact of weed species on high conservation value assets, including critical nesting habitats.
Wilsons Promontory Sanctuary – integrated deer control	Feral deer	Create a refuge and safe haven for Victoria's wildlife and restoration of key habitats, through control of feral deer; Reduce impact of feral deer on culturally significant sites and

neighbouring high-value agricultural land.

Identify and disrupt pathways of deer movement and work to eradicate isolated populations and incursions;

Increase community awareness, build community relationships and capacity.

Enhance knowledge of feral pig population size and distribution;

Strengthen capacity of public and private land managers to implement effective and humane feral pig control measures;

Support targeted management actions;

Develop an approach to best practice feral pig management in Victoria.

Develop a remote sensing tool to detect priority aquatic weeds across diverse landscapes;

Requirements to support operational weed detection and removal;

Train operational staff to use the tool;

Prioritise control of new target weed detections.

Deer free northwest Victoria

Feral deer

Advancing cross-tenure feral pig management in north-west Victoria

Feral pigs

Improving remote sensing technologies for priority aquatic weeds

Amazon frogbit, alligator weed, water hyacinth, salvinia

Tranche 2 (2021-22 to 2024-25) funding: \$4,813,000

Agency: Department of Land, Water and Planning, Parks Victoria

Project	Target species	Key activities
Expanded deer control under the Victorian Deer Control Program	Feral deer	Expand deer control activities through the Victorian Deer Control Program in identified areas of high environmental, agricultural, and cultural significance across the state; Delivery of aerial deer control, as well as additional capacity building activities for delivery staff and landholders.
French Island Feral Cat Eradication Project	Feral cats	Eradicate feral cats from French island to provide a sanctuary for local native wildlife. Strengthen the nation's populations of several threatened fauna species, including several wetland bird species that inhabit coastal salt marsh and Ramsar wetlands on the island.
Melbourne Peri-urban Invasive Program	Multiple pest animals and weed species	Control priority pest plants and pest animals that are impacting high value environmental areas in Melbourne's peri-urban area, and reduce the threat of these pests on adjacent private land including agricultural areas.
Intensifying Victorian Alpine Integrated Pest Animal and Plant Control	Multiple pest animals and weed species	Expand and intensify a suite of existing invasive species management programs delivered by Parks Victoria and Department of Environment, Land, Water and Planning, with a focus on alpine areas.
Victorian Arid Country Rabbit and Weed Control	Rabbits and multiple weed species	Facilitate capability and capacity building for Parks Victoria, North Central Catchment Management Authority (CMA), Mallee CMA and Traditional Owners, to expand pest plant and animal programs across the Semi-arid Woodlands of the Mallee and three of Northern Victoria's Ramsar sites: Hattah Lakes, Kerang Lakes and Gunbower Forest.

Queensland

Tranche 3 (2025-26) funding: \$627,714

Agency: Department of Primary Industries

Project	Target species	Key activities
Biological control of bellyache bush	Bellyache bush	Progress the biological control for bellyache bush, affecting agriculture and the natural environment in northern

		Australia, including rear and release of approved biological control agent and testing of a new agent for host specificity.
Brisbane feral deer incursion corridor management program	Feral deer	Focused deer management along the Brisbane local government boundary, to detect and suppress deer incursions impacting native habitat.
Consolidating deer management in north Queensland using conventional and thermal-assisted aerial-culling	Feral deer	Reduce and contain an isolated chital deer population in the Whitsunday Regional Council area through aerial culling. Environmental and economic assessments of deer impacts will be completed to encourage landholder support for program expansion.
Strategic deer management in central western Queensland	Feral deer	Stop the spread of two isolated populations of deer at the western edge of the species' Queensland range, through aerial-culling for suppression and possible local eradication, to minimise impacts to environment, agriculture and public safety.

Tranche 2 (2021-22 to 2024-25) funding: \$2,220,000

Agency: Department of Agriculture and Fisheries, Department of Environment and Science - Queensland Parks and Wildlife Service

Project	Target species	Key activities
Coordinated management of feral deer in Queensland	Feral deer	Undertake coordinated management of feral deer in Queensland. Deer will be managed by aerial and ground shooting at several demonstration sites in a range of Queensland environments.
Strategic invasive grass control to reduce risk of further invasion in Northern Queensland	Multiple invasive grass species	Engage with a wide range of land managers within the Queensland distribution of these grasses including local government, Indigenous, conservation and agricultural land managers to identify and control or eradicate strategic outlier infestations of these grass species on both private and publicly owned land.
Cape York biosecurity (feral animal control)	Feral pigs and wild stock	Remove feral pigs and wild stock (unsuitable for market) on State-owned land in collaboration with Traditional Owners. This work will broaden the biosecurity buffer in this priority Region.
Feral pig biosecurity risk	Feral pigs	Manage feral pigs on two key sites where pigs are known vectors of pathogen spread (Bunya Mountains National Park and in the Wet Tropics World Heritage Area).

Work will focus on mitigation of biosecurity risks associated with Phytophthora and Panama Disease (TR4) and the protection of priority natural values associated with wetlands.

High biomass grasses	Multiple invasive grass species	Improve biodiversity outcomes and enhance agricultural productivity by delivering control of priority invasive grass species over a range of protected areas. Management intervention will focus on the use of a range of chemical and physical control methods.
Predator control for the protection of endangered species	Multiple pest animal species	Manage predators on a number of national parks and contribute to existing programs aimed at the protection of threatened species from predators (cats, dogs and foxes).

Western Australia

Tranche 3 (2025-26) funding: \$639,850

Agency: Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development ; Department of Biodiversity, Conservation and Attractions

Project	Target species	Key activities
Supporting community-led feral pig suppression in WA	Feral pigs	Promote community-led action to deliver feral pig suppression working towards eradication of isolated populations in Western Australia. Aims to deliver greater coordination with industry, landholders, community group and other stakeholders.
From detection to eradication – harnessing precision tools and advanced analytics for targeted rubber vine control	Rubber vine	Suppress rubber infestations in the Kimberley region of Western Australia. Aims to improve detection and monitoring to enhance management decision making; Conduct cost-benefit analysis of eradication from the region.
Targeted weed control to protect wetlands and offshore island reserves of the Swan and Midwest Regions of WA	African boxthorn, golden crownbeard, buffel grass, Amazon frogbit, Geraldton carnation weed	Abate weed threats to significant ecological communities through integrated weed management, including targeted survey mapping and on-ground weed control in three

sub-projects to contribute to offshore island eradication.

Tranche 2 (2021-22 to 2024-25) funding: \$1,494,000

Agency: Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development, Department of Biodiversity, Conservation and Attractions

Project	Target species	Key activities
Demonstration of effective feral deer control in WA hotspots	Feral deer	Target two feral deer populations to demonstrate local eradication: one containing rusa deer, a C1 species requiring eradication, and one with red and fallow deer, both C3 species requiring management. By working collaboratively with the National Feral Deer Taskforce to trial selective deer feeders, and NSW Department of Primary Industries to train Departmental staff to perform Thermally Assisted Aerial Shooting (TAAS), this project will build capacity with the WA biosecurity framework to conduct best practice feral deer control.
Improving the efficacy of bait uptake by dogs and foxes	Wild dogs and foxes	Investigate how to improve the uptake of baits by both dogs and foxes through on-ground field trials, leading to the implementation of enhanced baiting on agricultural and government managed lands.
Gamba grass management	Gamba Grass	Increase targeted removal of this weed to prevent it from becoming established in northern Western Australia. Enable more intensive and effective control of this priority weed to prevent it from becoming established in northern Western Australia.
Prickly acacia management	Prickly acacia	Currently WA has a single infestation site of prickly acacia which is managed by the Kimberley Rangelands Biosecurity Association (KRBA) in collaboration with Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development (DPIRD). Increase the intensity of control programs to reduce the density of infestations, with the long-term goal to eradicate rubber vine from the region. In addition, the funding will allow refinement of current aerial surveillance with the use of digital cameras to improve detection of flowering plants.
Rubber vine management	Rubber vine	
Improving management tools for feral cats	Feral cats	Examine the strategic application of feral cat baiting using Eradicator across four sites to improve cost-effectiveness and efficacy.

South Australia

Tranche 3 (2025-26) funding: \$900,000

Agency: Department of Primary Industries and Regions South Australia

Project	Target species	Key activities
African lovegrass – building regional strength for national impact	African lovegrass	Collaboration between South Australia and New South Wales, to reduce the economic, environmental and social impacts of African lovegrass by building landholder capacity. Research trials to improve management is planned in both states.
Eradicating feral deer from the peri-urban regions of the national containment zone of South Australia	Feral deer	Coordinated effort to seek to suppress or eradicate small satellite feral deer populations before they spread, focused on the Clare Valley region, to protect horticulture and critically endangered threatened ecological communities.

Tranche 2 (2021-22 to 2024-25) funding: \$4,000,000

Agency: Department of Primary Industries and Regions

Project	Target species	Key activities
Eradication of feral deer from South Australia	Feral deer	Eradicate feral deer from South Australia and drive control activities during the initial 4 years of the 10-year program, during which the greatest level of investment is required and the largest reduction in feral deer is forecast. The project will align with the development of both State and National Action Plans for feral deer.
Eradication of wild dogs from SA sheep country	Feral dogs	Eradicate wild dogs from South Australia sheep country inside the Dog Fence for the first 4 years of the eradication program, which requires the greatest level of investment and will see the largest reduction in wild dog populations.
Priority weed control programs	Multiple weed species	Deliver state-wide, best-practice weed control programs and on-ground activities focused on the provision of support and advice, and regionally-based equipment, chemicals and expertise, enabling landholders to better control weeds.

Tasmania

Tranche 3 (2025-26) funding: \$143,787

Agency: Department of Natural Resources and Environment Tasmania

Project	Target species	Key activities
Improving feral cat control in high value landscape in Tasmania	Feral cats	Improve accuracy of the Felixer through target image data and enhancement of the recognition algorithm eliminating accidental targeting of non-target species (building on the project funded by Saving Native Species).
Managing priority weeds in specific locations across Tasmania Reserved Land Estate	Spanish heath, serrated tussock, African boxthorn	Reduce the biomass of key invasive plant species, providing support for longer term successful weed management outcomes, focusing on locations with high ecological and/or cultural value.

Tranche 2 (2021-22 to 2024-25) funding: \$1,575,000

Agency: Department of Natural Resources and Environment Tasmania

Project	Target species	Key activities
Regional Collaborative Deer Management, Tasmania	Feral deer	Partner with the local communities, local governments, and other stakeholders in the Launceston region and King Island to develop their awareness of the need to manage deer in peri-urban environments; Develop their capacity to plan and implement deer management, including evaluating and undertaking control options and operations.
Strategic management and control of feral pigs on Flinders Island	Feral pigs	Use a range of innovative techniques and technologies for the detection, surveillance, control and management of feral pigs on Flinders Island. The project will seek to remove pigs from priority agricultural and natural areas using best-practice methods and the use of trained contractors, in conjunction with Department of Natural Resources and Environment Tasmania officers.
Protecting the economic and natural assets of Tasmania's off-shore	Multiple pest animal and weed species	Add significant value to existing pest animal and weed control activities and extend that work and knowledge to a broader suite of strategically important offshore islands, to ensure the values present on those islands can be protected.

Islands from the impact of
vertebrate pests and weeds

Australian Capital Territory

Tranche 3 (2025-26) funding: \$412,870

Agency: Environment, Planning and Sustainable Development Directorate

Project	Target species	Key activities
Keeping biodiversity hotspots weed free	African lovegrass, St John's wort, Chilean needlegrass, serrated tussock, blackberry	Tackling ecosystem recovery through weed management plans to guide stakeholders; Establish a bush crew model whereby practitioners treat weeds in a holistic manner.
Thermal Assisted Aerial Control (TAAC)	Feral deer, feral pigs	Reduce the impacts of feral deer and pigs on conservation and culturally important areas and mitigate impacts on agricultural production, through an enhancement of the ACT TAAC program.
Parks Weed Management	St John's wort, orange hawkweed	Implement a coordinated, territory-wide approach to managing high-risk invasive weed species by combining targeted surveillance, site-specific control trials and collaborative knowledge-sharing.

Tranche 2 (2021-22 to 2024-25) funding: \$1,000,000

Agency: Environment, Planning and Sustainable Development Directorate

Project	Target species	Key activities
Invasive Species Management in the ACT	Multiple invasive species	Expand operational activities to prevent, eradicate, and undertake early containment of invasive species in priority areas, protecting agricultural and conservation values in threatened ecosystems.

Northern Territory

Tranche 3 (2025-26) funding: \$750,000

Agency: Department of Lands, Planning and Environment

Project	Target species	Key activities
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		Accelerate eradication through aerial surveys and strategic treatment for outlier infestations;
Eradicating priority prickly bushes in the Katherine and Barkly Tableland regions	Prickly acacia, mesquite	Re-engage and support landholders; Establish an eradication register for prickly acacia and mesquite; Seek to transition all infestations to monitoring.
Protecting Country: survey and control of rubber vine in the Gulf of Carpentaria	Rubber vine	Increase participation of Indigenous ranger groups and establish a cross-border working group with Queensland; Complete aerial surveys over priority coastal regions and provide support for landholders to conduct treatment.
Sustained action and surveillance: detecting and controlling outlier siam weed infestations in Arnhem Land	Siam weed	Delimitation surveys in Arnhem Land following detection of siam weed infestation on Croker Island; Survey and control siam weed across the region; Engage stakeholders and Indigenous ranger groups in extension and capacity building.

Tranche 2 (2021-22 to 2024-25) funding: \$1,418,000

Agency: Department of Environment, Parks and Water Security

Project	Target species	Key activities
Feral cat control to secure the future of the critically endangered central rock-rat	Feral cat	Expand the extent and duration of feral cat control and increase collaboration with Aboriginal Rangers and Traditional Owners, to boost the central rock-rat population in Tjoritja National Park. It will also significantly enhance monitoring of the feral cat and central rock-rat populations.
	Siam weed	Reduce the threat that Siam weed (<i>Chromolaena odorata</i>) currently poses to northern Australia by designing and delivering

Containment of Siam Weed in the Northern Territory		a coordinated Siam weed control program to contain core infestations and eradicate outliers in the Northern Territory.
Expand the Gamba Grass program in Litchfield National Park	Gamba Grass	Expand the gamba grass program to halt the rapid spread of the grass across the Litchfield National Park.

\$6 million has been allocated to regional delivery partner organisations to deliver on-ground pest animal and weed reduction activities that will protect and recover threatened species and ecological communities. Projects will focus on priority species and places identified in the [Threatened Species Action Plan 2022-2032](#).

Project	Organisation	Funding	Target Species	Key Activities
Integrated predator control supporting fauna recovery in priority nature corridors of the South Coast, WA	South Coast NRM	\$300,000	feral cats, foxes, rabbits	The project builds on the existing cross-tenure, multi-partner, integrated predator control activities on private land and between the Stirling Range National Park and Fitzgerald River National Park and in the Waychinicup National Park, focusing on controlling feral cats, foxes and rabbits, to support native species including the Malleefowl, Chuditch (Western Quoll) and Western Ground Parrot. The project will estimate the density (for a sub-set of sites), activity (encounter rate) and seasonality of introduced predators within private native grasslands on the Northern Plains. Introduced predator control will be conducted across both private and public land with management effectiveness assessed. The project will maintain the pressure on feral cat numbers while population monitoring and further planning is undertaken to inform the eradication goal of a larger feral cat program. Activities will include real-time monitoring cameras and response crews, continuation of multiple trapping methods, additional data analysis and
Plains-wanderer predator control and monitoring on the Northern Plains of Victoria	North Central CMA	\$182,248	feral cats, foxes	
French Island cat eradication	Melbourne Water Corporation	\$500,000	feral cats	

Controlling sambar deer to protect alpine bogs and fens in the Australian Alps	North East CMA	\$400,000	feral deer	further engagement with the French Island community. The project will control feral sambar deer at key sites, including EPBC-listed threatened ecological communities in the Victorian Alps, focused on improving the condition of Alpine Sphagnum Bogs and Associated Fens across 3 catchment management areas: North East, East Gippsland and West Gippsland. The project will involve the use of camera traps to assist in determining the density of deer across key sites. The project will help protect the Eastern Quoll population from feral cat predation, competition and exclusion impacts on north Bruny Island by removing feral cats through the use of 3 Felixer grooming traps over a 5-month period; and undertaking a feasibility assessment for a cat barrier fence across the Neck isthmus (or south of the Neck) to limit the movement of feral cats from the south to the north of the Island. The project will contribute to the reduction of the feral cat population on Three Hummock Island through the active maintenance and monitoring of 7 Felixer grooming traps over a 12-month period, and supplementary cat control measures. The project will install 110 4G-connected cameras to assist efforts to eradicate feral cats across the Dudley Peninsula for the benefit of KI echidnas and other threatened species. These cameras will provide a real-time monitoring network and notifications to on-ground staff about when and where feral cats are active, expediting the eradication efforts.
Priority actions for Eastern Quolls on north Bruny Island	NRM South	\$100,000	feral cats	The project will help protect the Eastern Quoll population from feral cat predation, competition and exclusion impacts on north Bruny Island by removing feral cats through the use of 3 Felixer grooming traps over a 5-month period; and undertaking a feasibility assessment for a cat barrier fence across the Neck isthmus (or south of the Neck) to limit the movement of feral cats from the south to the north of the Island. The project will contribute to the reduction of the feral cat population on Three Hummock Island through the active maintenance and monitoring of 7 Felixer grooming traps over a 12-month period, and supplementary cat control measures. The project will install 110 4G-connected cameras to assist efforts to eradicate feral cats across the Dudley Peninsula for the benefit of KI echidnas and other threatened species. These cameras will provide a real-time monitoring network and notifications to on-ground staff about when and where feral cats are active, expediting the eradication efforts.
Creating a Hooded Plover stronghold on Three Hummock Island	Cradle Coast Authority	\$200,000	feral cats	The project will install 110 4G-connected cameras to assist efforts to eradicate feral cats across the Dudley Peninsula for the benefit of KI echidnas and other threatened species. These cameras will provide a real-time monitoring network and notifications to on-ground staff about when and where feral cats are active, expediting the eradication efforts. The project will deliver strategic feral animal and weed control in the Great
KI Echidna monitoring, protection and recovery network	Kangaroo Island Landscape Board	\$250,000	feral cats	
Malleefowl protection in the	Alinytjara Wilurara	\$300,000	feral cats, foxes,	

Great Victorian Desert (South Australia)	Landscape Board		camels, buffel grass	Victorian Desert, supporting existing Malleefowl populations in the region. A follow-up LiDAR survey will increase knowledge of spatial distribution and size of the Malleefowl population. The project will deliver feral goat control through aerial shooting and dam decommissioning to improve the habitat for many threatened mallee birds, in particular Black-eared Miners and Malleefowl. Monitoring of targeted mallee bird species and habitat will improve the information base for future management.
Improving habitat viability for EPBC listed threatened mallee birds	Murraylands and Riverland Landscape Board	\$300,000	feral goats	The project will use cost effective feral animal control methods to address key threats to the Western Quoll and other EPBC-listed threatened species by reducing predation and resource competition. The project will continue efforts to eradicate feral cats from Dudley Peninsula through installing a further 100 4G-enabled cameras connected to the eVorta AI image recognition platform, to create a monitoring network of 300 cameras spanning the whole eradication area, including a buffer zone to the west of the cat-proof barrier fence. Information from these technologies will provide real-time notifications to on-ground feral cat control staff about when and where feral cats are active, expediting eradication efforts.
Idnya (Western Quoll) reintroduction program support (SA)	South Australian Arid Lands Landscape Board	\$500,000	feral cats, foxes, feral goats, rabbits	The project will support greater intensity in feral cat and fox control on the Southern Yorke Peninsula of South Australia to help the recently reintroduced Brush-tailed Bettongs and existing Hooded Plover and Malleefowl populations. It will also assist in preparing the project area for the
Kangaroo Island feral cat eradication	Kangaroo Island Landscape Board	\$500,000	feral cats	
Feral animal control to support the Marna Banggara landscape restoration project	Northern and Yorke Landscape Board	\$500,000	feral cats, foxes	

Continuing the eradication of feral pigs from Kangaroo Island in the Kangaroo Island NRM region	Kangaroo Island Landscape Board	\$800,000	feral pigs	reintroduction of Western Quolls and other locally extinct threatened mammal species in future years. The project will continue the implementation of the eradication effort by delivering rapid, targeted and intensive action to remove the last pigs to completely eradicate them from Kangaroo Island. Intensive surveillance will be undertaken, and a proof of freedom surveillance time commenced when the last known feral pig is removed. The project will focus on controlling gamba grass in areas of high biodiversity in the Cape York NRM region to protect threatened animals such as the Northern Quoll from hot, late season fires. Priority will be given to sites where localised eradication is possible or an intensive knockdown can be maintained beyond the life of the project. The project will engage key regional land managers and stakeholders to identify plan and initiate gamba grass management for biodiversity conservation in priority areas of the Top End. This project will prioritise biodiversity assets and conservation sites in the gamba grass eradication zone for targeted gamba grass management. Management actions contributing to eradication of gamba grass will be implemented in Kakadu National Park. The NatureMapr citizen science application will receive platform enhancements to provide real time alerts of Weeds of National Significance to state, territory and Commonwealth agencies, and real time alerts of Threatened Species Action Plan priority species. Enhancements and expansion of
Gamba grass control on Cape York, QLD	Cape York NRM	\$327,725	gamba grass	
Managing gamba grass for biodiversity conservation in priority areas of the Top End	Territory NRM Inc	\$540,000	gamba grass	
Enhancement of NatureMapr for pest and weed notifications	ACT NRM	\$300,000	Weeds of National Significance	

the Landholder Hub capability will support up to 100 ACT-based properties.

\$4 million has been allocated to support Indigenous Ranger Groups in northern Australia to undertake Indigenous led on-ground pest and weed management to protect biodiversity and cultural values. The North Australian Indigenous Land and Sea Management Alliance (NAILSMA) is coordinating delivery. Funds will be directed to priority projects, training and development opportunities and knowledge transfer opportunities. This initiative complements the Indigenous Ranger Biosecurity Program, by supporting our frontline rangers in the north to reduce the impact of pests and weeds that have naturalised and become invasive in Australia.

In September 2025, a new grant was awarded to NAILSMA to continue to support Indigenous Ranger Groups in northern Australia with pest and weed management. Additional \$2 million in funding.

For more information visit: [Protecting Country Against Invasive Species Program | NAILSMA](#).

Additional funding of \$4.26 million has been provided to reserve projects identified in the oversubscribed [Advancing Pest Animal and Weed Control Solutions Competitive Grant Round](#). Four new grants support research into novel approaches and new technologies to better manage pest animals and weeds.

Projects

Novel rat-specific toxin for improved management of rats in intensive livestock production systems

Delivered by: CSIRO, partnering with Australian Pork Limited, Poultry Hub, and Landcare Research NZ.

Current control strategies rely mainly on anticoagulant rodenticides, which can negatively impact non-target species. This project will assess the effectiveness and delivery of a newly designed analogue of the rat specific chemical toxin, Norbormide, in Australian Intensive Livestock Production Systems. This project aims to deliver cost-effective rodent control that significantly reduces non-target risks to livestock and native wildlife.

Development of drone detection technology to enhance Tropical Soda Apple control in rugged high-value grazing country in northern NSW

Delivered by: North Coast Local Land Services, partnering with Charles Sturt University, Southern Cross University, Kempsey Shire Council, Coffs Harbour City Council, Clarence Valley Council and Rous County Council.

Tropical Soda Apple (TSA) is native to South America but highly invasive in agricultural and natural landscapes in Australia. Current control and management strategies are proving effective in accessible and easy to monitor environments such as open pastures. However, present management efforts are at risk of failure as TSA is difficult to control in rugged 'out of sight' terrain. This project aims to develop

drone-based remote sensing technology to detect TSA. This will allow targeted control activities that will greatly increase the chances for regional-scale eradication.

Night-Adapted Eye survey and species classification system — realising the capacity for real-time and cost-effective monitoring of pests on a landscape scale

Delivered by: Monash University, partnering with Nocturnal Wildlife Research Pty. Ltd., Definium Technologies Pty. Ltd., Firmus Grid Pty. Ltd., University of Southern Queensland, Zoophotonics.

Current pest survey methods are mostly highly labour intensive, non-automated, and require the placement of devices in the field that need to be maintained. This project aims to utilise the power of high-performance computing and Artificial Intelligence to develop a hand-held digital sensor that can determine the distribution, density, and species classification of pests in many hectares of habitat in minutes.

Integrated chemical and biological control systems for established agricultural and environmental weeds

Delivered by: The University of Queensland, partnering with CSIRO, and Bayer AG.

The main chemical control tools deployed by farmers are either herbicides or biological control agents such as insects or fungal pathogens. Herbicides are often not entirely effective and can negatively impact non-target species including biological control agents. The goal of this project is to modify existing herbicides to become more effective, and to develop new herbicides that target an important plant enzyme not found in animals that allows for easier integration of chemical and biological control systems.

A further \$3 million has been provided for the following projects:

National Rabbit Disease Monitoring Program

Delivered by: CSIRO

The National Rabbit Disease Monitoring Program provides critical data on the various rabbit viruses circulating in Australia, to inform potential future rabbit biocontrol agents. It extends rabbit monitoring and diagnostic services, offering free testing services to community members to diagnose rabbit viruses in rabbits and hares that are found dead. In addition, CSIRO will select a representative sample to keep track of any new virus variants, new virus recombinants, and monitor general trends in viral variance and evolution. This investment builds on previous Commonwealth-supported projects managed by the Centre for Invasive Species Solutions (CISS).

Further information on the program can be found at CSIRO. Further information on rabbit biocontrol in Australia can be found at PestSmart.

Year 1 of Phase I – Future Proofing Rabbit Biocontrol

Delivered by: CSIRO

This contract provides funding to CSIRO to commence Phase 1 of a Future Proofing Rabbit Biocontrol program, which aims to produce Australia's next rabbit biocontrol virus using natural selection processes to obtain new Rabbit Haemorrhagic Disease Virus (RHDV) variants as candidates for future virus releases.

Resulting virus variants that overcome immunity to existing virus strains can be further assessed as potential candidates for registration and release as rabbit biocontrol agents.

Further information on rabbit biocontrol in Australia can be found at PestSmart

Community engagement in release of biocontrol agents

Delivered by: CSIRO

This project will undertake classical weed biocontrol for Spinyhead sida (*Sida acuta*, Phase III, mass rearing and release) and sea spurge (*Euphorbia paralias*, Phase III, mass rearing and release), which were identified as national biocontrol priorities. Activities will aim to advance biocontrol research and practice for these two species along the weed biocontrol pipeline over a two-year period, at which point their outcomes will be evaluated.

Siam weed biocontrol

Delivered by: Department of Primary Industries Queensland

This project will progress nationally identified research activities in the biological control of Siam Weed (*Chromolaena odorata*) in northern Australia. The project will undertake host specificity testing of a potential new biocontrol agent (the defoliating Erebid moth, *Pareuchaetes pseudoinsulata*). The project will also monitor the spread of Siam weed and the existing biocontrol agent (stem-galling fly, *Cecidochara connexa*) in north Queensland and the Northern Territory, through detailed surveys and mapping and provide training to Northern Territory field staff for monitoring distribution and impact of the gall fly.

Gorse biocontrol

Delivered by: Department of Energy, Environment and Climate Action Victoria

This project will progress nationally identified research activities in the biological control of Gorse (*Ulex europaeus*). The project will identify areas to search for new gorse biocontrol agents by assessing, mapping and matching native and invasive populations of gorse. This project aims to complete genetic analysis of gorse populations in Australia and its native range in western Europe; engage with community stakeholders in monitoring and collecting samples; establish a framework for effective biocontrol agent selection; and providing recommendations for the search for new biocontrol agents in the native range based on genetic and climatic compatibility.

Giant reed biocontrol

Delivered by: Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development New South Wales

This project will initiate foundational biocontrol research on giant reed (*Arundo donax*) in Australia. Population genetics, including number and origin of potential introductions into Australia, will be explored. Ecoclimatic models and risk assessments for two potential biocontrol agents (the shoot tip-galling wasp, *T. romana* and the armoured scale, *R. donacis*) will be developed to understand potential distribution. A test plant list and preliminary host-specificity testing of the shoot tip-galling wasp and armoured scale will be developed in Australian quarantine on key native and agriculturally significant species.

Funding of \$6.8 million provided for national coordination.

In August 2025, additional funding of \$2.77 million (excluding GST) awarded in grants to continue the National Coordination programs for feral deer, feral pigs and feral cats and foxes.

Projects

National Feral Pig Management Coordination Program

Delivered by: Australian Pork Limited

This grant provides co-investment to support delivery of the National Feral Pig Action Plan 2021 – 2031 which seeks to reduce impacts by protecting assets through the delivery of effective, coordinated, sustained and humane best practice management to suppress, or eradicate (where feasible), feral pig populations.

This includes supporting cross-tenure national feral pig management that continues to increase strategic regional coordination for sustained feral pig management; raise community awareness and capacity to apply humane, best practice management; and increase the adoption of best practice methods and systems.

In August 2025, new grant awarded to Australian Pork Limited (APL) to continue delivery of the National Feral Pig Management Coordination Program.

National Wild Dog Management Coordination Program

Delivered by: Australian Wool Innovation Ltd

This grant provides co-investment to support effective delivery of the National Wild Dog Action Plan 2020 -2030 that provides the national strategy to coordinate management of wild dogs and seeks to increase community awareness, understanding, capacity and adoption of humane, best practice wild dog management to reduce impacts on agricultural productivity and the environment.

This includes strengthening stakeholder involvement and facilitating cross-tenure management; raising community awareness and capacity to apply humane, best practice management; and increase the adoption of best practice methods and systems.

National Feral Deer Management Coordination Program

Delivered by: Department of Primary Industries and Regions South Australia

This grant will support delivery of the National Feral Deer Action Plan 2022-2027 to actively suppress feral deer populations to reduce their impact on Australia's agricultural productivity, environment, significant places of high conservation value, and communities.

This includes coordinating cross-tenure feral deer management across all states with particular emphasis on strategies to contain large populations, and control of small populations before they spread to protect high value assets.

In August 2025, new grant awarded to Primary Industries and Regions South Australia (PIRSA) to continue delivery of the National Feral Deer Management Coordination Program.

National Feral Cat and Fox Management Coordination Program

Delivered by: Centre for Invasive Species Solutions

This grant supports active promotion of best management tools to control feral cats and foxes, to reduce impact on agricultural production and environment assets, including a focus on the 20 places identified in the Threatened Species Action Plan 2022-2032.

This includes coordination of cross-tenure feral cat and fox management across all states and territories, and promotion of best practice tools for effective and humane control of feral cats and foxes.

In August 2025, new grant awarded to the Centre for Invasive Species Solutions (CISS) to continue delivery of the National Feral Cat and Fox Management Coordination Program.

Further information on the national Coordinators can be found at [Priority pest animals](#).

National Rabbit Management Coordination Program

Delivered by: Centre for Invasive Species Solutions

Provides funding to co-invest in a 2-year national rabbit management coordinator program to support best practice rabbit management.

The National rabbit management coordinator, Heidi Kleinert, was appointed in late 2024. Initial priorities include a communication and engagement plan to increase adoption of best practice integrated rabbit management; update of the pestSmart rabbit toolkit and glovebox guide; and coordination of a review of national rabbit standard operating procedures.

Further information on the National Coordinators can be found at [Priority pest animals](#).

National Weed Biocontrol Pipeline Strategy – initial phase

Delivered by: Centre for Invasive Species Solutions, partnering with CSIRO, Queensland Department of Agriculture and Fisheries, Agriculture Victoria, New South Wales Department of Primary Industries, Atlas of Living Australia and Wild Matters.

This contract will address the gap in national priority setting for weed biocontrol. A national weed biocontrol RD&E Alliance has been established. A priority setting framework has been developed. The Framework will be applied to produce a priority list of candidates for weed biocontrol. An estimate of costs to implement 5-year RD&E plans will be provided. All deliverables will be considered by the Environment and Invasives Committee.

Further information on the Strategy can be found at [Weeds Australia](#).

Reducing residual agricultural losses caused by feral pigs

Delivered by: Australian Pork Limited

There remains significant opportunity to reduce residual agricultural losses (and impact on natural assets) caused by feral pigs, increasing agricultural productivity and profitability which has flow on benefits to regional communities. The report will provide a useful input for governments, industry and community organisations working to reduce the impacts of feral pigs on agricultural production in Australia, including opportunities to extend engagement and networks, priority capacity building activities by industry and location and what other support/tools are needed to sustain long-term effective management.

Reducing residual agricultural losses caused by foxes

Delivered by: Centre for Invasive Species Solutions

There remains significant opportunity to reduce residual agricultural losses (and impact on natural assets) caused by foxes, increasing agricultural productivity and profitability which has flow on benefits to regional communities. The report will provide a useful input for governments, industry and community organisations working to reduce the impacts of foxes on agricultural production in Australia.

Reducing residual agricultural losses caused by feral deer

Delivered by: Department of Primary Industries and Regions South Australia

There remains significant opportunity to reduce residual agricultural losses (and impact on natural assets) caused by feral deer, increasing agricultural productivity and profitability which has flow on benefits to regional communities. The report will provide a useful input for governments, industry and community organisations working to reduce the impacts of feral deer on agricultural production in Australia.

\$2.2 million has been provided to the Australian Bureau of Agricultural and Resource Economics and Sciences (ABARES). The funding expands and continues the national prioritisation and better information projects to improve our understanding of the distribution, abundance and impact of priority established pest animals and weeds.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/pests-diseases-weeds/pest-animals-and-weeds/supporting-communities>